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CYBER THREAT INTELLIGENCE REPORT

Binance hit by record crypto theft of about $6.3 billion, attributed to North Korea's TraderTraitor

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BREACH | CRITICAL | CONFIRMED BREACH; INVESTIGATION AND FUND TRACING ONGOING | OVERALL CONFIDENCE: MODERATE

BOTTOM LINE UP FRONT

On 29 October 2026, starting about 20:05 UTC, attackers drained Binance hot wallets on ten or more blockchains, most of it in about 20 to 30 minutes. Binance puts the loss at about $6.3 billion [S4]. Blockchain analytics firms give slightly different figures: TRM Labs $6.36 billion, Elliptic $6.43 billion across 11 chains, Chainalysis about $6.4 billion [S5] [S6] [S7]. All sources describe it as the largest crypto theft on record, roughly four times the February 2025 Bybit theft [S1] [S2]. Binance's preliminary finding is that a compromised DevOps engineer's laptop gave the attacker access to a service container. From there the attacker submitted unauthorized withdrawals. Binance says it has found no evidence that a wallet private key leaked [S4]. It has since reported 'additional points of breach' and described a multi-step attack, not misuse of one engineer's permissions [S1] [S3]. Binance says user funds are safe and that it will cover all losses from its SAFU fund and company funds. It suspended withdrawals, revoked the affected address authorization, and promised a technical post-mortem and an updated Proof of Reserves [S4].

On Ethereum, the attacker abused EIP-7702, an Ethereum feature that lets an ordinary wallet run smart-contract code. They submitted one transaction carrying 50 pre-signed authorizations, one for each of 50 consecutive transaction counts (nonces), so that one would be valid when it ran. Together these delegated a Binance hot wallet to an attacker-controlled 'sweeper' contract. The delegation stayed active, so new deposits could be swept repeatedly [S5] [S6]. On the other chains, Binance wallets sent funds through ordinary, validly signed transactions. TRM therefore assesses that the most likely root cause is that the

attacker could make Binance's hot-wallet signing system sign arbitrary transactions; stolen keys are the less likely explanation [S5]. The preparation took at least 36 hours: the attacker funded an operator wallet with three small Tornado Cash withdrawals on 28 October, then tested and rehearsed the code on three wallets [S5] [S6].

TRM Labs attributes the theft with high confidence to TraderTraitor, the North Korean (DPRK) unit also associated with Lazarus Group and APT38. Chainalysis agrees, mainly because it watched stolen Binance funds mix with proceeds of the September 2026 Bitget theft, which had been attributed to the DPRK [S5] [S7] [S1]. Elliptic also leans toward the DPRK but adds caveats. The overlap at the shared address is small, about $39,000 of Binance funds. The attacker laundered more slowly than usual and used different methods. The root cause has not been published. No government agency has made an attribution, and Binance has not named an actor [S6]. Stablecoin issuers and others froze about $2.7 to $3 billion, almost all of it USDT and USDC [S5] [S6] [S4]. Estimates of what the attacker still controls range from about $2.4 billion (TRM) to $3.33 billion (Elliptic). The total includes 18,270 BTC and over 420,000 ETH, which no issuer can freeze [S5] [S6]. Totals are still changing, and the first reports said $5.8 billion.

For defenders outside the crypto industry, the lesson is the attack path. A developer or DevOps endpoint led to production infrastructure that could move money, and the controls between the two did not stop it. Treat engineer workstations, container and orchestration access, and transaction or payment approval systems as crown-jewel paths. Expect phishing and fake-support scams that use the incident as a lure, and continued DPRK recruitment-themed social engineering aimed at developers [S10] [S3].

Key judgments

VERY LIKELY · MODERATE CONFIDENCE
The U.S. government (FBI) will very likely publicly attribute the Binance theft to North Korea's TraderTraitor within the next 30 days, as it did within five days for Bybit. Supporting signs are the shared tradecraft and the observed mixing with Bitget proceeds. [S5] [S7] [S9] [S6]

ALMOST CERTAIN · MODERATE CONFIDENCE
Most of the roughly $2.4 to $3.3 billion that cannot be frozen (BTC, ETH, XRP, TRX, SOL) will almost certainly be laundered over the coming weeks through bridges, swap services and OTC brokers, and only a small share will be recovered. [S5] [S6] [S9]

LIKELY · LOW CONFIDENCE
Binance's post-mortem will likely show that the engineer's laptop was compromised through social engineering, such as a fake job offer, coding test or bogus project, in line with earlier TraderTraitor intrusions. The root cause is not yet published. [S3] [S6] [S10] [S11]

VERY LIKELY · MODERATE CONFIDENCE
Phishing, fake refund and fake 'account verification' scams that use the Binance incident as a lure will very likely target crypto holders, including U.S. users, while withdrawals stay disrupted. [S4] [S1]

> ALMOST CERTAIN · HIGH CONFIDENCE
> DPRK actors will almost certainly keep targeting software developers and DevOps staff with recruitment-themed lures and trojanized tools, including at organizations outside the crypto sector that hold credentials or access worth stealing. [S10] [S11] [S9]

INDICATORS OF COMPROMISE

Only one network indicator for this incident appears in open reporting: an Ethereum address that Elliptic and The Hacker News report receiving both Binance and Bitget proceeds. TRM, Chainalysis and Elliptic keep their full attacker-address lists in their own products or blocklists, and none are reproduced in the public write-ups as of 30 October 2026. The other entries are behavior patterns from this incident, plus historical TraderTraitor indicators from earlier cases (Bybit 2025, CISA AA22-108A) labeled as such for context.

Type	Indicator (defanged)	Context	Provenance	First seen	Source
wallet	`0x15104a9ce0f08a8f0075a0869ae80e795fe0feb7`	Ethereum address that received funds from both the Binance theft and the DPRK-attributed September 2026 Bitget theft, first flagged by ZachXBT. Elliptic notes only about $39,000 of Binance funds reached it, so it may be a shared launderer, not the thief. Screen deposits and counterparties against it.	REPORTED	2026-10-29	[S3] [S6]
other	`Single transaction carrying 50 EIP-7702 authorizations signed by one wallet for consecutive nonces, delegating to the same contract`	Method used to delegate the Binance Ethereum hot wallet to an attacker sweeper contract at 20:20 UTC on 29 Oct. TRM advises treating any request for many authorizations across a nonce range as a sign of compromise.	REPORTED	2026-10-29	[S5] [S6] [S2]
other	`EIP-7702 set-code transaction (transaction type 0x04) whose authorization list references an organization's treasury or hot wallet`	EIP-7702 authorizations travel in a set-code transaction (type 0x04). Monitoring treasury wallets for any such delegation puts TRM's recommendation into practice. The reasoning is ours; the sources do not give the transaction type.	DERIVED		[S5]

Type	Indicator (defanged)	Context	Provenance	First seen	Source
other	`Operator wallet funded by three small Tornado Cash withdrawals about 36 hours before the theft`	Preparation pattern seen in this incident, Bybit and KelpDAO. TRM cites it as a TraderTraitor trait.	REPORTED	2026-10-28	[S5] [S3] [S6]
other	`Bitcoin peel chain splitting 18,270 BTC into outputs of 1,000 BTC and 100 BTC (19 addresses)`	Initial handling of stolen BTC, in the same block as the theft. None had reached a service as of 30 Oct, 07:00 UTC.	REPORTED	2026-10-29	[S5] [S6]
other	`Tron laundering addresses that receive exactly 1 TRX, then a larger amount, then forward it onward`	Automated laundering sequence Chainalysis observed in the hours after the theft.	REPORTED	2026-10-29	[S7]
domain	`bybit-assessment[.]com`	HISTORICAL (February 2025 Bybit case): Lazarus-linked domain registered on 20 Feb 2025. Not observed in the Binance incident. Listed only as TraderTraitor-related context for recruitment-lure hunting.	REPORTED	2025-02-20	[S11]
email	`trevorgreer9312[@]gmail[.]com`	HISTORICAL (February 2025 Bybit case): WHOIS registrant email tied to a Lazarus persona and to the Contagious Interview fake-job campaign. Not observed in the Binance incident.	REPORTED	2025-02-20	[S11]
other	`UpdateCheckSync() function in an Electron/Node.js app that posts to a PHP endpoint, AES-decrypts the response, writes it to the temp directory and runs it via child_process.exec()`	HISTORICAL TraderTraitor downloader behavior from trojanized crypto trading apps (CISA AA22-108A, 2022). Useful for hunting on developer endpoints, but not confirmed in the Binance intrusion.	REPORTED	2022-04-18	[S10]

Indicators are defanged (hxxp, [.], [@]) so they cannot be clicked. "Reported" means stated in a source; "Derived" means inferred by the analyst from the source material and should be validated before blocking.

TACTICS, TECHNIQUES & PROCEDURES (TTPS)

According to Binance, the intrusion began with a compromised DevOps engineer's laptop. The attacker used that access to reach a service container in Binance's withdrawal infrastructure and submit unauthorized withdrawals. Binance later found further points of breach [S4] [S1]. The initial compromise method is unknown. TraderTraitor has historically targeted crypto-company developers and administrators with fake job offers, coding tests and trojanized Electron apps [S10] [S6]. The attacker prepared for at least 36 hours: an operator wallet funded through Tornado Cash, then attack code tested on two wallets and rehearsed on a third [S5]. On 29 October, beginning at 20:05 UTC, Binance hot wallets on XRP Ledger, Solana, Optimism, Bitcoin, Tron and other chains signed valid transfers to attacker addresses. On Ethereum, a batch of 50 pre-signed EIP-7702 authorizations delegated a hot wallet to a sweeper contract, which emptied it and kept sweeping new deposits for hours [S5] [S6]. To get ahead of freezes, the attacker sold stablecoins to market makers and DEX aggregators at a 10 to 26 percent loss and borrowed ETH on Aave against USDT, moving mostly into assets that cannot be frozen [S5] [S6].

Threat actor

TraderTraitor · also tracked as Lazarus Group, APT38, Jade Sleet, Slow Pisces, UNC4899

Attribution confidence: Moderate · **Motivation:** Financial gain to fund the North Korean state · **Suspected origin:** North Korea (DPRK)

TRM (high confidence) and Chainalysis (assessment strengthened by funds mixing with Bitget proceeds) name TraderTraitor [S5] [S7]. Elliptic agrees on the DPRK but warns that the address overlap is small and the laundering pattern differs [S6]. Binance has not named an actor, and no government attribution exists yet [S1] [S6]. The other aliases come from the FBI's Bybit attribution coverage [S11]. We rate attribution Moderate, not High, because it rests on on-chain analysis by commercial firms and the root cause is unpublished.

MITRE ATT&CK mapping

Tactic	Technique	Procedure observed	Detection opportunity
Resource Development	T1608 Stage Capabilities	The attacker funded an operator wallet with three small Tornado Cash withdrawals, deployed sweeper code, tested it on two wallets and rehearsed on a third about four hours before the attack. [S5] [S6]	Mostly invisible to the victim. On-chain monitoring for new contracts that interact with organization-linked wallets.
Initial Access	T1566.003 Phishing: Spearphishing via Service	Suspected, not confirmed. TraderTraitor historically contacts developers and DevOps staff with recruitment lures on social and messaging platforms. Elliptic names fake coding tests and bogus projects as the likely vector. [S6] [S10] [S3]	Report and block recruiter contacts that push developers to download code or run 'assessment' projects. Monitor dev endpoints for unknown repositories executing.

Tactic	Technique	Procedure observed	Detection opportunity
Execution	T1204.002 User Execution: Malicious File	Suspected, based on historical TraderTraitor tradecraft. Trojanized Electron/Node.js apps fetch an encrypted payload, write it to temp and run it via child_process.exec(). [S10]	Alert on Node/Electron processes spawning shells or binaries from temp directories on engineer workstations.
Lateral Movement	T1078 Valid Accounts	The attacker used access from the compromised DevOps engineer's laptop to reach a production service container. Binance says the attack involved more than one engineer's permissions. [S4] [S1] [S3]	Baseline which identities and devices reach production containers. Alert on new devices, unusual hours or new geographies.
Execution	T1609 Container Administration Command	From the service container, the attacker submitted unauthorized withdrawal transactions that Binance's signing infrastructure signed across chains. [S4] [S5]	Audit exec and attach events into production containers. Alert on interactive sessions in withdrawal or signing services.
Persistence	T1098 Account Manipulation	Closest ATT&CK analog: an EIP-7702 delegation of the Ethereum hot wallet to an attacker sweeper contract stayed active, letting the attacker sweep new deposits at least six more times over about 3.5 hours. [S5] [S6]	Monitor treasury wallets for any EIP-7702 delegation and alert immediately (TRM recommendation).
Impact	T1657 Financial Theft	Theft of about $6.3 to $6.43 billion in crypto assets from hot wallets across 10 to 11 chains within minutes, followed by rapid conversion into assets that cannot be frozen. [S4] [S5] [S6] [S7]	Velocity and value thresholds on outbound treasury transfers. Real-time alerts to issuers and analytics partners to speed freezes.

Detection & hunting

Queries are built from the reported behavior and indicators. They are untested; tune field names for your environment.

Electron or Node.js app spawning a shell or a temp-directory binary on a developer workstation `SIGMA`

```
title: Node or Electron Child Process From Temp Path (TraderTraitor-style downloader)
status: experimental
logsource:
  category: process_creation
detection:
  parent:
    ParentImage|endswith:
      - '\node.exe'
      - '/node'
      - 'Electron'
      - 'Helper (Renderer)'
  child_shell:
    Image|endswith:
      - '\cmd.exe'
      - '\powershell.exe'
      - '/bash'
      - '/zsh'
      - '/sh'
      - '/osascript'
  child_temp:
    Image|contains:
      - '\AppData\Local\Temp\'
      - '/tmp/'
      - '/private/var/folders/'
  condition: parent and (child_shell or child_temp)
falsepositives:
  - Legitimate developer tooling, npm scripts and Electron app updaters
level: medium
```

Based on the CISA AA22-108A description of the TraderTraitor UpdateCheckSync() loader. Expect noise on developer machines. Tune with allowlists of known projects.

Developers running freshly cloned 'assessment' projects that reach out to the internet `KQL`

```
let devices = DeviceInfo | where DeviceName has_any ("dev", "eng", "build") | distinct DeviceId;
DeviceProcessEvents
| where Timestamp > ago(14d)
| where DeviceId in (devices)
| where InitiatingProcessFileName in~ ("node.exe", "node", "npm", "python.exe", "python3")
| where ProcessCommandLine has_any ("npm install", "npm run", "node index.js", "node server.js")
| join kind=inner (
    DeviceNetworkEvents
    | where Timestamp > ago(14d)
    | where RemoteIPType == "Public"
    | project DeviceId, NetTime = Timestamp, RemoteUrl, RemoteIP, NetPid = InitiatingProcessId
) on DeviceId
| where NetTime between (Timestamp .. Timestamp + 10m)
| summarize Urls = make_set(RemoteUrl, 50) by DeviceName, AccountName, ProcessCommandLine
| order by DeviceName
```

Hunting aid for fake coding-test lures. Device naming filter is a placeholder; replace it with your own developer device group. Review results manually.

Interactive exec into production signing or payment containers `SPLUNK SPL`

```
index=k8s_audit sourcetype=kube:apiserver:audit objectRef.resource=pods objectRef.subresource IN (exec,
attach) objectRef.namespace IN ("payments", "treasury", "signing", "prod")
| stats count earliest(_time) as first latest(_time) as last values(sourceIPs{}) as src
values(objectRef.name) as pods by user.username
| eval first=strftime(first, "%F %T"), last=strftime(last, "%F %T")
| sort - count
```

Based on Binance's report that a service container was used to submit withdrawals. Namespace names are placeholders. Compare users and source IPs to an approved break-glass list.

REMEDIATION ACTIONS

Exposure

Product	Affected	Fixed in	CVE	CVSS	EPSS	CISA KEV	KEV due date
Binance exchange hot wallets (Ethereum, Bitcoin, Tron, XRP Ledger, Solana, Arbitrum, Optimism, Base, Avalanche, Polygon, NEAR)	Binance-operated hot wallets and withdrawal service; Binance says customer balances are covered	Binance revoked the affected authorization; withdrawal service is being rebuilt; timeline to resume withdrawals not confirmed	None	N/A	N/A	No	N/A

Immediate (0–24 hours)

- Warn staff and clients who hold crypto on Binance not to trust unsolicited 'refund', 'verification' or 'withdrawal re-enable' messages, and to use only the official app or site for status updates. `SOC` [S4] [S1]
- Any organization that handles crypto (treasury, payments, clients in fintech) should screen counterparties and incoming deposits against the reported shared Ethereum address and against analytics-vendor labels for this incident. `SOC` [S3] [S6] [S5] [S7]
- Organizations that operate Ethereum wallets should check them now for active EIP-7702 delegations and set alerts for any new delegation. `IT OPS` [S5]

Short term (1–7 days)

- Review who and what can reach production containers that move money or sign transactions. Remove standing access from developer laptops and require just-in-time, approved, logged access. `IT OPS` [S4] [S5]
- Run the developer-endpoint hunts in this report and check for unapproved 'take-home test' or recruiter-supplied code executed in the last 90 days. `SOC` [S10] [S6]
- Brief engineering and DevOps staff on DPRK recruitment lures (fake jobs, coding tests, trading or utility apps) and how to report them. `SOC` [S10] [S11]
- Enforce phishing-resistant, hardware-bound MFA (FIDO2 security keys or platform passkeys) for admin, cloud console, CI/CD and orchestration access. `IT OPS` [S10]

Long term

- Separate signing infrastructure and approval paths by asset, chain and value tier. Require independent multi-party approval for high-value or bulk outbound transfers, including wire and ACH workflows outside crypto. `LEADERSHIP` [S5]
- Treat developer and DevOps workstations as privileged access devices: dedicated hardened machines or isolated VMs for production work, no personal or test code on them, and EDR with strict application control. `LEADERSHIP` [S10] [S4]
- Build and test an incident playbook for rapid fraudulent-transfer response that includes bank, issuer and law-enforcement (FBI/IC3) contacts. Fast freezes recovered about 44 percent here. `LEADERSHIP` [S6] [S9]

Workarounds & compensating controls

- Set velocity and value limits with automatic hold on outbound payments or transfers that exceed baseline, so a compromised signing path cannot drain funds in minutes. `IT OPS` [S5] [S6]
- Network-segment production signing and payment services so they accept commands only from a small set of hardened jump hosts, not from general developer endpoints. `IT OPS` [S10] [S4]

Actions marked with an owner: SOC = security operations, IT Ops = system and network administration, Leadership = risk and communications decisions.

SOURCES

[S1] BleepingComputer: Binance links $6.3 billion crypto theft to compromised DevOps laptop
Published 2026-10-30 · **B2** Usually reliable, probably true
Briefing source; reports Binance statements and TRM/Chainalysis attribution

[S2] SecurityWeek: $6 Billion Binance Hack Bears Hallmarks of North Korea's TraderTraitor
Published 2026-10-30 · **B2** Usually reliable, probably true
Briefing source; good summary of TRM mechanics and attribution

[S3] The Hacker News: Binance Suffers Security Breach
Published 2026-10-30 · **B2** Usually reliable, probably true
Briefing source; includes Elliptic caveats and the shared Ethereum address

[S4] Binance: Binance Security Incident Update
Published 2026-10-30 · **A2** Completely reliable, probably true
Primary victim statement; preliminary, post-mortem pending

[S5] TRM Labs: North Korea steals USD 6.36 billion from Binance in the largest hack in history
Published 2026-10-30 · **A2** Completely reliable, probably true
Primary on-chain analysis and attribution (high confidence); figures as of 00:30 UTC 30 Oct

[S6] Elliptic: Binance: the largest hack in history
Published 2026-10-30 · **A2** Completely reliable, probably true
Independent on-chain analysis; DPRK attribution with stated caveats; figures as of 07:00 UTC 30 Oct

[S7] Chainalysis: Binance exploit: latest findings and response
Published 2026-10-30 · **A2** Completely reliable, probably true
Independent attribution to TraderTraitor based on mixing with Bitget funds

[S8] Chainalysis: $387M Bitget theft (2026)
Published 2026-10-01 · **A2** Completely reliable, probably true
Context: the DPRK-attributed Bitget theft whose proceeds mixed with Binance funds

[S9] FBI / IC3: North Korea Responsible for $1.5 Billion Bybit Hack (I-022625-PSA)
Published 2025-02-26 · **A1** Completely reliable, confirmed by other sources
Historical government attribution of Bybit to TraderTraitor; precedent

[S10] CISA: TraderTraitor: North Korean State-Sponsored APT Targets Blockchain Companies (AA22-108A)
Published 2022-04-18 · **A1** Completely reliable, confirmed by other sources
Historical TraderTraitor TTPs and mitigations

[S11] The Hacker News: Bybit hack traced to Safe{Wallet} supply chain attack
Published 2025-02-27 · **B2** Usually reliable, probably true
Historical analog: developer machine compromise led to the Bybit theft; actor aliases

Grades use the Admiralty scale: letter = source reliability (A completely reliable to F cannot be judged), number = information credibility (1 confirmed to 6 cannot be judged).

MISCELLANEOUS

Timeline

Date	Event	Source
2026-09-24	The $387M Bitget theft, attributed to DPRK actors; its proceeds later mixed with Binance funds.	[S8] [S7]
2026-10-28	The attacker operator wallet receives three small Tornado Cash withdrawals.	[S5] [S6]
2026-10-29	Early in the day, the attack code is tested on two wallets and rehearsed on a third. About 4 hours later it is installed on a Binance hot wallet.	[S5]
2026-10-29	From 20:05 UTC, Binance XRP Ledger wallets send 233.46M XRP. Solana, Optimism, Bitcoin (18,270 BTC at 20:20), Tron and other chains follow.	[S5] [S6]
2026-10-29	20:20 UTC: one transaction carries 50 EIP-7702 authorizations. The Ethereum hot wallet is swept about 3.5 minutes later (167,464 ETH and 1.615B USDT).	[S5] [S3]
2026-10-29	21:01 to 22:26 UTC: Tether, Circle, Ripple and World Liberty Financial freeze attacker-held stablecoins. A second wave hits Avalanche and Polygon after 23:00 UTC.	[S5] [S6]
2026-10-30	00:08 UTC: the Arbitrum Security Council moves 8,426 ETH and 74.6M ARB out of the attacker wallet. 00:30 ET: Chainalysis announces attribution to TraderTraitor.	[S5] [S7]
2026-10-30	Binance publishes an incident update citing a compromised DevOps engineer laptop, a $6.3B impact and about $3B frozen, and pledges SAFU-backed coverage.	[S4]

Relevance to Indianapolis, Indiana & managed clients

Indiana organizations have little direct exposure to the theft itself. Binance has said customer losses will be covered [S4]. Indiana residents and employees who hold crypto on the platform may face withdrawal delays and are likely targets for refund and 'account security' scams that use the incident; managed IT clients should get a short user advisory. The sources do not say whether Binance.US is affected, so do not assume either way. The broader lesson applies to every sector in the state. The breach went from one engineer's laptop to production systems that move money. Indianapolis-area software firms, manufacturers with in-house development, healthcare systems running DevOps pipelines, universities, and state and local government IT teams all have engineers whose endpoints reach production. DPRK actors routinely approach developers with fake recruiter

offers and coding tests [S10] [S11]. Small and mid-size businesses, and managed service clients in particular, should apply the same controls to payment approval workflows (ACH, wire, payroll) as to crypto signing: dual approval, value and velocity limits, and phishing-resistant MFA for anyone who can release funds or administer production.

Intelligence gaps

- Root cause: how the DevOps engineer's laptop was compromised, and what the 'additional points of breach' were. Binance's post-mortem is pending.
- How the attacker got valid signatures on nine non-Ethereum chains without a private key leak (TRM's hypothesis: compromise of the signing system).
- Final loss and frozen figures. Estimates range from $5.8B (early) to $6.43B stolen and from $2.54B to $3B frozen. Attacker-controlled holdings are put at $2.4B (TRM) or $3.33B (Elliptic).
- No government attribution yet. Watch for an FBI PSA with attacker address lists, as issued for Bybit.
- Full attacker address lists are held in vendor products and blocklists. Only one address is publicly reported.
- Whether endpoint malware, file hashes or C2 infrastructure from the laptop compromise will be published.
- Whether Binance.US or other affiliates were affected, and when Binance withdrawals fully resume.

Other notes

- Figures disagree across sources because they use different snapshot times and pricing: Binance about $6.3B, TRM $6.36B, Elliptic $6.43B across 11 chains (Elliptic includes NEAR), Chainalysis about $6.4B at the time of theft or $5.912B in an earlier estimate.
- Elliptic's caveats on attribution: the stablecoin hold times (37 minutes on Ethereum, 46 on Tron) were slower than typical DPRK behavior, the laundering used market makers and DeFi lending, not bridges, and the Bitget overlap is small.
- Elliptic excludes a further $169M that left Binance after the suspension, judging it unconnected to the attacker.
- Speed of freezing mattered. Tether froze the main receiving wallet 37 minutes after the USDT arrived, and Circle followed within minutes. About 94 percent of frozen value is stablecoins [S6].
- This incident follows the DPRK-attributed KelpDAO hack (April 2026) and Bitget theft (September 2026), which suggests sustained, high-tempo DPRK targeting of exchanges in 2026.

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